

Nicholas Gray

Senior Product Designer · Enterprise Healthcare Workflows, Design Systems, AI-Assisted UX
Wake Forest, NC · 803-306-3647 · nic.gray.dsgn@proton.me
linkedin.com/in/nicholaspggray · nicgraydesign.us

SUMMARY

Product designer with over a decade turning fragmented healthcare operations — care navigation, provider onboarding, contract pricing — into structured IA, validated interaction models, and implementation-ready specs. Systems-first and accessibility-aware, comfortable owning ambiguous problems end to end and aligning product, engineering, and operations without direct authority.

EXPERIENCE

Optum (UnitedHealth Group) Raleigh, NC · July 2018 – Present

Product Experience Designer — Design Systems & DesignOps

- Led UX and interaction design for a guided care navigation experience across mobile and web, reframing a fragmented content library into a care path → journey → activity → recommendation model so members could see their next step and support advocates could reference the same structure. Post-launch reporting showed a 16% reduction in repeat calls and a 10.5% increase in accepted personalized offers.
- Specified enterprise workflow experiences for fee schedule and contract pricing management — search, guided create/edit/deactivate, AI-assisted discovery, approval routing, change tracking, audit visibility, and bulk-action patterns — replacing processes previously spread across Excel, SharePoint, and email approvals.
- Designed an AI-assisted provider onboarding experience covering role-based dashboards, work-queue triage, AI summaries and suggested next actions, duplicate detection, missing-document outreach, and credentialing workspaces, with human-in-the-loop review at each decision point.
- Translated ambiguous operational requirements into structured IA, interaction models, validation states, and Figma prototypes that gave product, engineering, and operations stakeholders a concrete basis for alignment — search vs. filter vs. keyword scan, page-level vs. license-level selection, delta-based change states, and approval logic.
- Applied and pressure-tested enterprise design-system patterns across product work — component states, alert and warning variants, selection and bulk-action behavior, floating panels, responsive grid guidance — routing gaps back through GitHub intake and design review instead of inventing one-off UI.
- Authored a DesignOps needs-assessment survey across the design org, presented first-round findings, and converted them into prioritized pilots spanning Figma file standardization, component audits, shared templates and toolkits, branching governance, and library analytics — maintaining a pattern library used by 3 design teams across 10 initiatives, averaging ~120 component insertions per week with low instance detachment.
- Facilitated research-informed iteration through usability scripts, moderated feedback sessions, prototype walkthroughs, and accessibility reviews for mobile and web care navigation experiences.
- Built accessibility-aware decisions into component and workflow design — WCAG-aligned tokens, keyboard interaction and focus order, and screen-reader considerations for mobile filters — in partnership with engineering at handoff.
- Advanced AI-assisted design practice through an internal builds community of practice: reusable prompt packs, generated documentation, and human-in-the-loop review patterns shared with other designers.

ByDesign — Independent Design Practice Raleigh, NC · August 2015 – Present

Founder — Freelance Product & Experience Designer (concurrent with full-time role)

- Deliver end-to-end UX/UI for client digital experiences — flows, wireframes, high-fidelity comps, and Figma prototypes — aligning business goals with user needs on selective freelance engagements.
- Lead discovery workshops and design reviews; document decisions, variants, and component behavior so work stays consistent across channels and hands off cleanly.

Paradigm Innovation Raleigh, NC · January 2018 – June 2018

Industrial & Interaction Designer

- Developed interactive product interfaces grounded in user research, usability testing, and competitive analysis; built low- to high-fidelity prototypes to validate flows and IA.

- Resolved complex physical and regulatory constraints into intuitive UI for high-accuracy environments, partnering with engineering on feasibility and handoff quality.

SELECTED WORK

OnboardIQ — AI-Assisted Provider Onboarding Optum

Redesigned provider onboarding from work-queue triage through credentialing, using AI summaries and suggested next actions with human review at every decision point. Role-based IA, operational visibility, and exception handling for duplicate records and missing documentation.

Care Pathways — Guided Care Navigation Optum

Reframed a healthcare content library into a guided navigation model organized around life events, spanning mobile and web with deliberate parity decisions. Research-informed iteration through usability scripts, moderated sessions, and prototype walkthroughs.

Fee Schedule Platform — Centralizing Pricing Operations Optum

Turned spreadsheet-and-email contract pricing workflows into a single platform concept: standard and AI-enabled search, guided create/edit/deactivate, role-based approvals, bulk edits, change tracking, and post-audit visibility.

SKILLS

Product & UX design — End-to-end product design · Information architecture · Interaction design · Complex enterprise workflow design · Research-informed iteration · Usability testing · Ambiguity framing

Design systems — Component design & specification · Variants and states · Design tokens · Pattern libraries · Governance intake & design review · Documentation · Figma libraries and branching

Accessibility — WCAG 2.1-aligned design · Keyboard interaction and focus order · Contrast and color usage · Screen-reader considerations · Semantic guidance at handoff

AI-assisted UX — Human-in-the-loop review patterns · AI summaries and suggested actions · Confidence and exception states · AI prototyping (Figma Make, Vercel)

Tools & collaboration — Figma (expert) · Axure · Adobe Creative Suite · Rally · Aha! · Pendo · GitHub · Cross-functional delivery with product, engineering, research, and operations · Mentorship and peer review

EDUCATION

Master of Industrial Design North Carolina State University, 2016

B.A. Applied Mathematics UNC Asheville, 2010